



Having a professional massage during pregnancy can be a real treat. Besides feeling blissful, research shows that it eases aches and pains, helps you sleep, and can reduce stress.

ASK A DOCTOR

I'm feeling so down about my size. Will things get better? You're not alone in battling with your self-image in pregnancy. For some women, their changing body shape can create negative feelings.

There's no set emotional response to pregnancy, but in addition to coming to terms with a momentous life and body change, you are under the influence of fluctuating hormones, all of which affects your mood and can add to feelings of negativity. Feeling a bit down in pregnancy is often helped by reassurance and support from loved ones. Talking over your fears and concerns may help relieve anxiety. If you speak to other pregnant women, you might find that they feel the same.

However, if you think you might be depressed or your sad feelings are affecting your behavior, you must speak to your doctor for additional support with your mental health.